

MEASLES VACCINATION GUIDANCE

VA Ann Arbor Health Care System, 4/21/25

Veterans are considered measles-immune if:

- They have completed 2 doses of MMR vaccine series
- They were in the service after 1980 (this is when the military began vaccinating recruits with the two dose series)
- They had laboratory-confirmed measles

There is no need to check measles immune titers in these situations. The immune response to measles is multifactorial, and a negative antibody titer does not mean a Veteran is at risk of infection.

Note the measles vaccine is 93% effective with 1 dose and 97% effective with 2 doses (CDC)

There is a small subset of people that may be at risk but who were previously thought immune:

- Persons born before 1957
- Persons who did not complete the current 2 dose vaccine series

In these cases, measles immune titers may assist you and the patient with shared decision making pertaining to whether they would like to proceed with additional vaccinations.

If a Veteran is non-immune, they can undergo 2 dose vaccine series, with doses at least 28d apart.

Most cases of measles in the United States in this century have been related to international travel. Please discuss with patients whether they had MMR when traveling to areas with high endemic rates of measles, including sub-Saharan Africa, Asia, and eastern Europe.

Non-vaccinated persons who are exposed to measles should be offered post-exposure prophylaxis (PEP).

- MMR vaccine within 72 hours of exposure

If exposed person is pregnant or heavily immunocompromised, intravenous immunoglobulin may be considered within 6 days of exposure. Recommend infectious disease consultation.